FREE CARD

# My Safe Adults Network

A hand to fill in with five safe adults, one on each finger, plus photo boxes, ways to ask for help and a wallet card to cut out.

**WHO IT IS FOR**
Autistic children and young people, with the parents, carers, teachers and SNAs who support them.

**NCCA STAGE**
Primary (all classes) · Junior Cycle

**Easy read**

A safe adult is a person I trust. I can tell them anything. I have five safe adults. One for each finger.

## How to use this resource

- Sit together at a calm time. Trace the child's hand on page 2, or use the hand idea and write one safe adult on each finger.
- Stick a photo of each safe adult in the photo boxes on page 3. Add where they usually are and how to contact them.
- Practise asking for help using the scripts on page 4. Say the words out loud, more than once.
- Cut out the wallet card on page 4. Keep it in a bag or pocket. Check it every term.

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Version 1.0 · safe-adults-network-card

# My safe adults hand

Put your hand on a page and draw around it with a pencil. Write the name of one safe adult on each finger. Start with the thumb. If you have fewer than five, that is fine. Add more later.

**My five safe adults (one for each finger)**

**Thumb:** _____

**Pointer finger:** _____

**Middle finger:** _____

**Ring finger:** _____

**Little finger:** _____



I have a hand of safe adults.



A safe adult is a person I trust.



I can tell them anything.

## Safe adults at home, at school and in the community

| Where | Who could be a safe adult? | My safe adult |
|---|---|---|
| At home | Mum, Dad, grandparent, aunt, uncle, a carer | _____ |
| At school | Teacher, SNA, principal, school secretary, year head, DLP | _____ |
| In the community | Doctor, public health nurse, club leader, neighbour, Garda | _____ |
| By phone or online | Childline (1800 66 66 66), a trusted adult I can message | _____ |


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# My safe adults: photos

Stick a photo in each box. Write their name, where I can find them and how to contact them.



**At home**

Name: _____ Where: _____ Phone: _____

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**At home**

Name: _____ Where: _____ Phone: _____

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**At school**

Name: _____ Where: _____ Room: _____

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**At school**

Name: _____ Where: _____ Room: _____

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**In the community**

Name: _____ Where: _____ Phone: _____

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**Someone else I trust**

Name: _____ Where: _____ Phone: _____

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## How to choose a safe adult

- ☐ They listen to me and do not laugh at me.
- ☐ They help me feel safe. They say my body is mine.
- ☐ They do not ask me to keep a secret that makes me worried.
- ☐ They believe me, and they do not get angry that I told.
- ☐ They know what to do, or they find someone who does.
- ☐ I can reach them: I know where they are, or I have their number.

# Practise asking for help

Practise when you are calm. Say the words out loud. You can say them, write them, show a card, or send a text. Any way is fine.

You feel worried and you do not know why.



**I feel worried. Can I talk to you?**

Something happened and it felt wrong.



**Something happened. I need to tell you.**

Your safe adult is busy.



**It is important. Can we talk soon? When?**

You told and nobody helped.



**I told you before and I still need help. Please help me.**

You find it hard to talk.



**I find it hard to say. Can I write it down or show you?**

## Wallet card to cut out



### My safe adults

1 _____ 2 _____ 3 _____ 4 _____ 5 _____

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### If I need help, I can say:

"I need to tell you something." Childline: 1800 66 66 66 · Text 50101

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### Notes for adults

- Support the child to choose, not just to be told. Include adults the child is already comfortable with. Safe adults are people, not roles. A family can have fewer than five.
- Aim for **at least one safe adult in each setting**, and at least one who is not a family member living in the same house. Check the list every term, or when circumstances change.
- Tell each safe adult they are on the list and what it means. They need to know to listen, believe, stay calm, not promise to keep a secret, and tell the Designated Liaison Person (DLP) or Tusla if there is a child protection worry. See *Children First* (2017).
- Some autistic children find eye contact, speaking or approaching an adult very hard. Agree other ways in: a card, a text, a drawing, or a signal. Make sure the safe adult knows the signal.
- The message is: **we all have the right to feel safe**, and **nothing is so awful that we can't talk about it with someone we trust**. If the first person does not help, keep telling until someone does.

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## Curriculum links

### NCCA and Department of Education alignment

- Primary SPHE (1999), strand **Myself**, strand unit *Safety and protection*; supported by the Stay Safe programme (safe adults, saying no, telling).
- Junior Cycle SPHE (2023), Strand 1 **Understanding Myself and Others** and Strand 3 **Relationships and Sexuality**: help-seeking and safe relationships.
- NCCA guidance on RSE for students with special educational needs: teach help-seeking explicitly with visual supports and practice.

### Universal Design for Learning

Every Autism & Me resource offers more than one way in: pictures and words together, an easy-read line, things to do with your hands, and scripts to practise. Keep the learning aim the same for everyone, and change the route. No diagnosis is needed to use any support in this resource.

## Getting support in Ireland

### Childline (ISPCC)

Free, 24 hours: phone 1800 66 66 66, text 50101, or chat at childline.ie. For anyone under 18.

### Emergency

112 or 999 — Gardaí, ambulance or fire. Use it if someone is in danger now.

### Tusla – Child and Family Agency

Report a worry about a child's safety to your local Tusla social work duty team. Contacts at tusla.ie.

### Your school

Talk to the Designated Liaison Person (DLP) for child safeguarding, a class tutor or year head.

### Parentline

Support for parents and carers: 01 873 3500, parentline.ie.

### Text About It

Free text support any time: text HELLO to 50808.

### Autism & Me

Questions about this resource or training for your school: contactautismandme@gmail.com · autismandme.ie

### If a child tells you something worrying

Stay calm. Listen, and believe them. Do not promise to keep it a secret. Write down what they said in their own words, with the date. Pass it on the same day: in a school, to the Designated Liaison Person (DLP); otherwise to Tusla. If anyone is in immediate danger, call 112 or 999. Follow *Children First: National Guidance for the Protection and Welfare of Children* (2017).

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